

Flippo's Interview Guide

Questions, prompts and CTAs for Mary and Larry, written so every answer can be cut straight into a Meta ad or the website.

Four days after launch, don't chase numbers they don't have. Chase the two things an ad can't fake: Larry's skepticism and the moment it flipped. The best spot you will cut is "old-school owner who hates tech says it was easy." Larry is that guy. Mary is the "why we said yes" voice. Interview them separately for ad clips, then together for the website.

WHO

Larry — owner, old-school, not a technology person. Your skeptic and your best hook.

Mary — manager, the one who said yes and trusts the vision. Your "why" and your mechanism voice.

Chris — their business advisor, if he is around. One question, one clip.

Before you press record

- Full-sentence answers that include the question. "Yes, it was easy" is unusable. "Honestly, I didn't want another piece of technology at my desk" is a hook. Say this once at the start and remind them when they slip.
- When an answer lands, ask for it again shorter. The second take is almost always the ad.
- Hold three seconds of silence after every answer. Natural reactions, nods and laughs become cuts.
- They talk to another owner, not to you. "Pretend you're telling the guy who owns the bowling alley in Paso."
- Locations: the actual front desk, the party room, the cages. Never a blank wall.
- Film vertical and horizontal in the same sitting. Two phones on tripods if you have them.
- Get a signed release from both, and from any family you film at the desk.
- Don't lead with your words. Never ask "would you say it's seamless?" Venue words beat software words, and Larry's grumpy version beats your polished one.

1. Hook lines

The first two seconds of an ad. Fish for the skeptic.

- Larry, be honest. What did you think when Mary first brought this to you?
Looking for: "I thought it was a waste of money" or anything blunt.
- Finish this sentence: "I've run this place for ____ years and I don't do ____."
- What's the dumbest-sounding thing a tech salesperson has tried to sell you before?

Positions Atlas against the noise without you saying it.

- Mary, what did Larry actually say the first time you showed him the app?

Her retelling of his skepticism is often funnier than his.

- How many apps are on your phone right now, Larry?

A laugh and a number. Great cold open.

- If I'd told you a month ago your guests would sign the waiver on their phone, what would you have said?

2. Before

The problem in their words. These become the agitate beat.

- Walk me through a Saturday at the front desk before this. Where did it pile up?
- A family has a great party here. What happened next, before the app? How did you reach them again?

Looking for: "We didn't."

- Memberships: what was the hardest part about selling them, or keeping them going?

Memberships are their stated priority; let them say why.

- What's your deadest afternoon of the week, and what have you tried to fix it?
- What does your card system know about a family that walks in? What doesn't it know?

Sets up "knows the card, not the family."

- How many people have been through this building this year, and how many of them could you text tonight?

3. The flip

The moment it clicked. This is the middle of every testimonial ad.

- What was the first thing you saw on launch day that made you go, "oh, okay"?
- Mary, when did you know Larry was on board?
- Tell me about one specific guest or family from this weekend and what they did with it.

One story beats ten adjectives.

- What did the kids at the desk say about it? Did they need training?
- What surprised you?

Open on purpose. Let them pick the feature.

- Was there anything that didn't work the first day?

Honesty clip. Owners trust a testimonial that admits a hiccup.

4. Mechanism in their words

They sell it so you don't have to.

- Explain to another owner how a guest gets into the app. Pretend I've never seen it.
- What happens now when a party leaves?
- What's the one feature you'd be mad if we took away?
- Why does having memberships inside the app matter to you specifically?
- Show me on the desk tablet what you do when a kid walks up with the app open.

Film the hands, then the face.

5. Objection busting

One clip per objection. These are the retargeting ads, so get each one in two lengths: the full answer, then a one-sentence version. Read the objection out loud exactly as written so their answer starts with the objection in it.

"Nobody downloads apps."

- Someone tells you "nobody downloads apps." What do you tell them?

Looking for: there's nothing to download, they're already standing there for the waiver.

- Did you have to convince a single guest to scan it this weekend?

"My staff won't use it."

- Someone says "my 16-year-old at the desk is never going to use this."
- How long did it take your newest employee to get it?

"I don't have time to run promotions."

- Someone says "I don't have time to run promotions." What's your honest answer?

Looking for: once it's set up it runs itself; Andrew's team set it up.

- How much of your week does this take, really?

"I don't have a laptop for the desk."

- Someone says "I'd need a whole second computer at my counter."
- What are you actually running this on at the desk?

Film the device as they say it.

"My card system already does loyalty."

- You've got a card system. Why did you need this on top of it?

Looking for: the card system knows the card; this reaches the family.

- Did anything about your card system or POS have to change?

"It's too expensive."

- Someone says five hundred a month is a lot for an arcade. What would you say?

Looking for: one party or a few memberships covers it. Don't feed them the number; let them do the math on camera.

- What does one birthday party bring in here?

"Our customers are families, they don't want another app."

- What did the parents say when they saw it?
- Did anyone complain about it? Anyone at all?

"I'll do it later / after the holidays."

- If an owner told you he'd wait until after party season to turn this on, what would you tell him?

Urgency in their mouth, not yours.

"I'm not a tech person."

- Larry, you're not a tech guy. Why did you go along with this?
Possibly the single best clip of the day.
- What would you tell another owner who says the same thing about himself?

"We tried loyalty before and it didn't stick."

- Have you tried punch cards or a loyalty thing before? What happened to it?
- Why do you think this one is different?

"I don't trust a young company."

- Andrew's team is a group of college students. Did that worry you?
Address it head on; the answer disarms it for every other owner.
- How was it actually working with them? What happened when something went wrong?

6. Direct-to-camera CTAs

Get three or four takes of each. Lens, not you. Short, then shorter.

Finish-the-sentence CTAs

- "If you run a place like ours..." Finish it however you want.
- "If you do birthday parties..."
- "If your Tuesday afternoons look like mine used to..."
- "If you've got a waiver line on Saturday..."
- "If you hate technology like I do..." (Larry)

Fence-sitter CTAs

- What would you tell an owner who's on the fence?
- What would you tell an owner who's sure this isn't for him?
- What would you tell the version of yourself from six weeks ago?
- Who should NOT do this?
A disqualifier makes the endorsement believable, and Meta's algorithm loves a polarizing line.

Action CTAs

- Tell them exactly what to do next. Keep it to one sentence.
Looking for: "Book the fifteen minutes. He builds it in front of you."
- "Take the fifteen-minute call. Worst case you..." Finish it.
- "Ask Andrew to build your app on the call. That's what sold me." Say that in your own words.
- "Don't call me, call him." (Larry, deadpan, if he's up for it)

Identity CTAs

- Larry: "I'm Larry, I own Flippo's, and I don't like technology." Then let him go wherever he goes.

- Mary: "I'm Mary, I run the floor at Flippo's, and here's what changed on Saturday."
- Both together: "We're Flippo's in Morro Bay." Then one line each.

Website hero clip.

Social-proof CTAs

- Would you recommend this to the owner down the street who competes with you? Why or why not?

Hesitation here is gold; competitive honesty reads as real.

- If another arcade owner called you tomorrow and asked about it, what's the first thing you'd say?
- Say something to the owners in Bakersfield and Fresno who are going to see this.

Holiday-season CTAs (for the December ads)

- Party season is coming. What would you tell an owner about turning this on before Thanksgiving?
- What are you planning to push to your guests in December?

7. Reactions and B-roll to prompt

Film the face first, then the screen.

- Hand Mary the manager dashboard and ask her to find one number she likes.
- Ask Larry to scan a guest in himself. First try, no coaching.
- Ask a real family at the desk if they'd be in a video, then film them signing the waiver and seeing the app save to the home screen.
- Send a push notification to Mary's phone while the camera is on both of them.
- Ask Larry to read one of the automated offers out loud and react to it.
- Ask Mary to show the membership card in the app and say what it replaced.
- Ask Chris, if he's around: "As their business guy, why did you say yes to this?"
- Wide shots: empty weekday floor, busy Saturday floor, the cages, the party room mid-party.

SIX WEEKS

Don't fish for "parties rebooked" or "revenue up" at week one. Ask about the first weekend today. Come back around mid-November for the numbers interview: guests in the app, memberships sold through it, parties booked from a push, reviews earned. That becomes the second testimonial spot and the proof block in the VSL.

EDIT NOTES

Tag clips by section number as you offload them. Every objection clip gets a 15-second cut with the objection on screen as text. Every CTA gets a 5-second cut for ad endings. Captions burned in; most owners watch muted.